

WOW!

If the DNA in all your cells was put end-to-end, it would reach to the Sun and back around 600 times.

Thymine always pairs with adenine.

Cytosine always pairs with guanine.

CHROMOSOMES

Inside the nucleus of a body cell there are two sets of 23 chromosomes, one inherited from Mom and one from Dad. Each chromosome is made up of one long, coiled-up strand of DNA. When a cell divides (see page 13) its chromosomes appear X-shaped, like this one. The bands show the position of genes on the chromosome.

CLOSE RELATIVES

Our closest living relative is the chimpanzee. It's perhaps not surprising then that chimps share around 96 percent of their DNA with humans. Both belong to a group of mammals called primates that also includes gorillas and monkeys.



IDENTICAL TWINS

These twins look very similar because they share identical DNA and genes. However, each twin is also affected by different life experiences, so each has their own individual character. Scientists investigate identical twins to see whether or not, for example, the chance of developing a particular disease is due to genes or upbringing.



▲ **IDENTICAL TWINS FESTIVAL** In addition to being fun, gatherings like this one give scientists the chance to study similarities and differences between identical twins.